

Zach Zukowski

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TOKENIZED-PRODUCT INVESTMENT MANAGEMENT · DUE DILIGENCE · PORTFOLIO STRATEGY

- ~\$500M AUM · 250 investments (~25% deployment rate) · ~75 DATs analyzed, 18 invested · LayerZero seed (~80x)
- 8 SSRN papers · 14 federal comment letters
- 16 USPTO patent applications across 8 families (Canonical-State Architecture for multi-agent AI research)

SUMMARY

Tokenized-product investment researcher who underwrites tokenized money-market funds, deposit tokens, stablecoins, and yield wrappers from sourcing through committee. First hire at Borderless Capital, an RIA; now founder of Tokenization Systems. Focus: tokenized-product diligence, portfolio construction, build-versus-hold allocation, NAV and mNAV analysis, deal sourcing · scenario modeling, Monte Carlo, difference-in-differences · pre-seed to Series C, Digital Asset Treasuries.

EXPERIENCE

Founder · Tokenization Systems

Feb 2026 to Present

- Authored an eight-paper SSRN-live research program covering the [Control Layer Intensity Index](#) (CLII) for gateway concentration, the [Minimum Viable Equivalence Pack](#) (MVEP) for institutional tokenization diligence, programmable monetary-policy design ([Adaptive Tokenomics](#)), [governance concentration](#), and [operational risk in token economies](#). Three additional papers in development (B5 Bankruptcy-Priority Misaligned Incentives, A7 Control Layer Theory, SVB Reserve Concentration); methodology paper in preparation.
- Contributed fourteen comment letters across a federal regulatory program (OCC bank stablecoin engagement [RIN 1557-AF41](#) plus [supplemental control-layer extension](#); [Treasury GENIUS Act state similarity](#); FDIC payment-stablecoin reserve standards [RIN 3064-AG19](#) and stablecoin-subsidiary issuance approvals [RIN 3064-AG20](#); FinCEN AML/CFT [FINCEN-2026-0034](#); FinCEN-OFAC PPSI sanctions [FINCEN-2026-0100](#); joint banking AML/CFT [91 FR 18304](#)); [Routing the Dollar](#) prepared for the Federal Reserve Fifth Conference on the Dollar's International Roles (Jun 2026); [Governance Concentration](#) accepted for publication at Frontiers in Blockchain.
- Working dialogue with capital-markets infrastructure operators on stablecoin, deposit-token, tokenized-deposit, and tokenized-equity deployment.

Senior Investment Analyst, Digital Assets · Borderless Capital (RIA; first hire)

Dec 2019 to Feb 2026

- Sourced the **LayerZero seed round** investment for Borderless, returning ~80x; the underlying cross-chain interoperability thesis preceded the firm's Cross-Chain Ecosystem Fund by two years.
- Prevented hostile governance capture on a top-25 blockchain via voting-path simulation under coalition-attack scenarios; surfaced the vulnerability and mitigation route before exploitation.
- Identified ~15% misreporting of circulating supply in a top-25 Layer 1 protocol by independently modeling its tokenomics (emission schedule, vesting, burn dynamics); the discrepancy had propagated to CoinMarketCap and CoinGecko, and was corrected after partnering with the protocol's foundation engineers.
- Shipped 250 portfolio investments (~25% deployment rate) across ~10 institutional funds (~\$500M AUM) from a 1,000+ deal pre-seed-to-Series-C funnel, with build/partner/hold recommendations to committee.
- Predicted Thorchain's **\$200M insolvency 13 months in advance**, leading to a no-exposure posture before the predicted failure mode materialized.
- Advised 100 portfolio companies 1-on-1 on token mechanism design (stablecoin reserves, governance-token allocation and incentive design, yield wrappers, burn/emission dynamics); standards defined in [Introduction to Tokenomics](#).
- Built quantitative token-economic models forecasting emissions, fee capture, pricing and subsidy-to-revenue trajectories, and governance concentration under wide scenario ranges; supply-equilibrium and slashing dynamics supporting Layer 1 business-model and mechanism-design advisory.
- Built an automated SEC-filing and press-release monitoring pipeline (n8n + Apify) covering 30+ Digital Asset Treasury Stocks (DATs), tracking coins held, cash, debt, and share counts (float, adjusted, fully diluted) per issuer to compute multiple on NAV (mNAV) apples to apples across the sector; analyzed ~75 tokenization offerings in 2025 and invested in 18; AI-assisted diligence workflows reducing subscription-document review from ~4 hours to ~1 hour per deal.
- Mapped jurisdictional tax / regulatory advantages of DAT structures over direct crypto holding: Japan's Metaplanet DAT cuts crypto capital-gains tax from up to 55% to 20% (equity rate, further reducible via Japan's IRA structure).
- Built apples-to-apples multiple on NAV (mNAV) methodology for Digital Asset Treasury Stocks (DATs) and shipped a daily mNAV dashboard sourcing SEC filings and press releases; standardized treatment of non-crypto assets in the numerator across issuers (issuer-reported mNAV figures use inconsistent conventions that undermine cross-DAT comparison).
- Translated regulatory change (GENIUS, CLARITY, Singapore MAS, MiCA, state money-transmitter and trust-charter regimes) into product, reserve, routing, and compliance decisions across U.S., Singapore, Cayman / BVI / Bermuda, and EU; coordinated cross-functional partner work spanning Product / Engineering, Risk (operational-risk taxonomy), and Legal.

SELECTED RESEARCH

- [Minimum Viable Equivalence Pack](#). Ten-category institutional diligence standard; finds bank-chartered stablecoin issuers face ~22x the regulatory capital requirements of money-transmitter-chartered issuers at \$40B scale; production-validated by Circle's BUIDL March 27, 2025 incident (23 hours of limited availability). Editor-invited submission to the Journal of Financial Regulation.
- [Three Tokenization Strategies](#). Each of three strategies satisfies different MVEP categories with measurably different strength (Regulated Collateral Circuit, Multi-Issuer Yield Stack, Tokenized Equity Rails); Securitize as cross-strategy concentration risk.
- [Seven Dollars](#). Cross-product framework for major dollar-denominated digital products and how dollars move across them; CLII / MVEP decoupling; stress propagation through dependency chains (SVB, Circle pool, Paxos).
- [Dollar v3](#). Four digital-dollar objects (payment stablecoins, tokenized deposits, deposit tokens, yield wrappers); typology for inheritance of control environments, backstop expectations, and failure modes; load-bearing for institutional scoping of product shape and counterparty topology.
- [Routing the Dollar](#). Prepared for Federal Reserve / FRBNY Fifth Conference on the Dollar's International Roles (Jun 2026). Gateway concentration; CLII across 19 gateways with Tier 1 a 56% / 44% Coinbase-Circle duopoly; on Ethereum, transfer volume doubled while unique counterparties fell 25% and cross-gateway connections dropped from 5.8% to 2.6%.
- [Who Controls Agentic Payments?](#) First control-layer measurement of agentic payments (x402). May 2026 facilitator concentration: Base HHI 6,009 by count and 4,040 by dollar volume; Solana 4,203 and 4,915, all above the 2,500 highly-concentrated threshold at under 14 months of market age.
- [FSB AI Sound Practices response](#). Filed 2026-07-01; the program's first international standard-setter filing. Three practice additions (composition-chain documentation, execution-authority evidence, dependency-concentration monitoring) plus the invited nonbank case study on settlement facilitators.
- [Adaptive Tokenomics](#). Industrial control engineering (PID, Proportional-Integral-Derivative) applied to token-supply emission as programmable monetary-policy mechanism; 806-run agent-based simulation battery; PID emission control cuts worst-case node-count variance from CV (coefficient of variation) 0.544 (static emission) to 0.087 (PID), functioning as downside insurance under competitor-shock attack.
- [Operational Risk in Token Economies](#). Operational-risk taxonomy (74 risk vectors, 64 testable controls, 31 program objectives) mapped to a 624-scenario battery; Lido V3 staking-vault case study.
- [Auditing Governance Concentration Beyond Token Allocation](#). Accepted for publication at Frontiers in Blockchain. Live-governance audit of 52 token protocols: launch allocation does not predict governance concentration; DePIN governance is more concentrated than DeFi after correction (Cohen's d = 0.65, a directionally robust medium effect).
- [Tokenized Equity Vehicles](#). Comparative analysis of Robinhood Stock Tokens and Backed xStocks across legal form, investor claim, liquidity architecture, and corporate-actions reconciliation; the binding constraints that determine whether institutions can hold, trade, and report tokenized equity.

TECHNICAL

Methods: policy-shock impact estimation (difference-in-differences), Monte Carlo simulation, PID controller design (industrial control engineering), coalition-power analysis, supply equilibrium modeling, build-versus-partner framework design

Data: Dune Analytics, Nansen Pro, Artemis, DefiLlama, CoinGecko, Helius (Solana), Etherscan, Blockscout (EVM), Spacescope, Token Terminal, Tally (DAO governance), rated.network, Beaconcha.in (validator data), FRED (macro); automated SEC filing and press release monitoring

Stack: Python (pandas, statsmodels, scipy, matplotlib), R (fixest, did, synthdid), SQL (DuneSQL, Trino), JavaScript / TypeScript; 22 MCP and API connections wrapping the data sources above plus GitHub; Claude.ai + Claude Code + Cursor with 36-skill library and 17-file living-knowledge architecture; n8n, Apify, Git / GitHub

RECOGNITION

- Uniswap Foundation governance committee (2025)
- ETHDenver pitch judge (2025)
- [Introduction to Tokenomics](#) article publicly endorsed by Binance founder CZ on day of publication

FRAMEWORKS AUTHORED

- Control Layer Intensity Index ([CLII](#)), Minimum Viable Equivalence Pack ([MVEP](#)), MVEP-gated Conditional Pass-Through ([MGCPT](#); [AG19 Rec 7](#)), Three-Category Reserve Disclosure ([3CRD](#)).

EDUCATION

High Point University | B.S.B.A., Business Administration (Magna Cum Laude) · Investment Club President
· Lingnan University, Hong Kong (exchange)

2018